

BEFORE THEY FOLLOW,

IT FOLLOWS

A SPEC RELAUNCH CAMPAIGN | 2026

THE FILM

A MODERN HORROR CLASSIC

DIRECTOR	David Robert Mitchell
RELEASED	2014 (Cannes) / 2015 (Wide Release)
STARS	Maika Monroe, Keir Gilchrist
BOX OFFICE	\$23.2M worldwide on a \$1.3M budget

96%

CERTIFIED FRESH

"One of the most formally inventive horror films in years."

A.V. CLUB

ROTTEN TOMATOES

FOR THOSE WHO AREN'T FAMILIAR...

IT FOLLOWS centers on a young woman, Jay, who is cursed after a sexual encounter and begins being relentlessly pursued by a slow, shape-shifting entity that only she and others she “passes” the curse to can see.

The creature can look like anyone and walks toward its target at an unhurried but unstoppable pace, forcing Jay to constantly stay on the move.

As she tries to survive and understand the rules of the curse, she realizes there may be no permanent way to escape it, only temporary relief.

A sequel, **They Follow**, is currently in development and expected to continue the story in the coming years.



ANXIETY YOU CAN'T ESCAPE

The entity moves slowly. But it never stops. That's the film.

GROWING UP

Adulthood feels like a slow, inevitable doom creeping toward you with no way to outrun it permanently.

MORTALITY

Death is always coming for everyone, walking toward us from a distance, patient and unstoppable.

TRAUMA

The curse passes from person to person. It never fully disappears, it only changes its focus.

ANXIETY

The monster mirrors the feeling of constantly looking over your shoulder. Always there. Never named.

A GENERATION MISSED IT

8-14

YEARS OLD IN 2015

AWARENESS GAP

Many Gen Z fans know the film by reputation but have never actually seen it.

NO ANCHOR MOMENT

Without the 2015 cultural wave, new fans have no shared reference point or communal experience to latch onto.

SEQUEL PRESSURE

They Follow needs a primed audience. Cold viewers won't fully connect with what the sequel builds on.

THE OPPORTUNITY

THE SEQUEL CHANGES EVERYTHING

The announcement of They Follow creates a natural, time-limited window, which is the kind of moment that can be built into a genuine event.

BUILT-IN CURIOSITY

Every They Follow announcement is free marketing for It Follows. Audiences will seek the original.

FRANCHISE MOMENT

Horror sequels perform better when the original is culturally active, not sitting dormant on a streaming shelf.

GENRE IS MAINSTREAM

The Substance, The Ugly Stepsister, Longlegs, MaXXXine. Horror has never been more mainstream; the timing couldn't be better!

COMMUNITY READY

Reddit horror boards, horror TikTok, YouTube essay culture are constantly hungry for canon-setting, conversation-starting content.

HORROR FANS DON'T JUST WATCH MOVIES,

THEY WANT TO BE PART OF THE CONVERSATIONS AROUND
THEM.

BEFORE THEY FOLLOW, IT FOLLOWS.

A relaunch that turns It Follows from a beloved horror film into a cultural event, using socials, creator partnerships, and community engagement to make the original impossible to ignore before the sequel arrives.

IT'S LURKING...

"The cast doesn't promote the film. They document being followed."

THE CONCEPT

Each cast member posts normal, aesthetic lifestyle photos. But every image contains a subtle anomaly hidden in the background that is never acknowledged.

THE ANOMALIES

A figure standing too still in the distance, someone facing away, centered in depth of field, a person appearing across multiple posts or reflections that don't match.

THE RULE

Nothing is acknowledged in captions. No winking. No promotion. The cast simply lives their life, and **It** follows.

WHY IT WORKS

Instagram is built for background scanning. Fans investigate instead of just watching. Horror becomes participatory.



FIND IT BEFORE IT FINDS YOU

LA + NYC location-based hunt. An entity appears in curated posts and real-world coordinates. Fans track these anomalies, and the first to find it unlocks exclusive access to the film.

01 PHASE 1 SIGHTINGS



Instagram posts and story pins show vague sightings in LA and NYC. Blurry images, CCTV-style clips. Nothing confirmed.

02 PHASE 2 PROXIMITY



A map with each location tagged creates a guide on where to go. Social media begins tracking movement in real time.

03 PHASE 3 FIND IT



Pop-up physical activation points in each city with limited 2-3 hour windows. The hunt goes IRL.

04 PHASE 4 CONTACT



Discovery triggers a phone number or QR code leading to exclusive an It Follows or They Follow ticket redemption.

THE HORROR CREATOR ECOSYSTEM

DEAD MEAT

YouTube

@deadmeatjames

The definitive horror YouTube channel! A retrospective reaches the most engaged horror audience online. Their seal of approval drives watch-throughs.

FOUNDFLIX

YouTube

@foundflix

Specializes in horror analysis and ending-explained content. A pre-sequel mythology deep-dive seeds questions and excitement before They Follow arrives.

HEIDI WONG

TikTok / Instagram

@heidiwong

Translates horror recommendations into engaging, digestible short-form content that sparks curiosity and drives viewers to seek out films for themselves.

BLOODY DISGUSTING

Editorial / Social

@bdisgusting

Horror's most widely-read publication. Coverage, interviews, and exclusive campaign content reach superfans and casual readers.

FANGORIA

Magazine / Social / Podcast

@fangoria

The original voice of horror culture. A Fangoria cover — ideally with Maika Monroe — anchors the campaign in legacy credibility. Print and digital reach.

PATRICK WILLEMS

YouTube Essay

@patrickwillems

Long-form video essayist for the cinephile-adjacent horror audience. A 'Why It Follows Matters' piece becomes shareable cultural canon.

THE RIGHT VENUE = THE RIGHT AUDIENCE

Targeted to arthouse and cinephile venues, not multiplex chains. The goal = cultural credibility, not volume.

THE AERO THEATRE

LOS ANGELES, CA

- Operated by the American Cinematheque, this theatre carries the cultural weight of a genuine archival event, not a simple rerun.
- Aero programming is handpicked; inclusion signals that *It Follows* has earned canonical status in the horror genre.
- Draws a mixed crowd: LA film industry insiders, young creative professionals, and horror fans all around.

METROGRAPH

NEW YORK, NY

- Regularly programs modern cult horror and elevated genre films, with a curated reputation.
- Screening events frequently include cast and crew Q&As, which is perfect for simultaneously generating press coverage, social content, and community moments.
- The Lower East Side location draws a young, culturally engaged audience and the NYC media and editorial community.

THE FOLLOWED EXPERIENCE

2 days. Small groups. Walk through the world of It Follows. Disasterpeace plays throughout. 10-15 minutes.

JAY'S BEDROOM

THE FILM'S EMOTIONAL CENTER

Dressed to match the film, with her the twin bed, pale sheets, open window with sheer curtains, as a small television plays static in the corner. A figure is visible through the window, standing on the lawn below, not moving. Disasterpeace's opening theme plays low.

THE POOL

THE FILM'S MOST ICONIC SEQUENCE

Guests enter a room lit with ambient pool lighting, mimicking the film's cold blue-white glow. Lawn chairs are arranged as they are in the film's climax, with a towel draped over one and a transistor radio playing the film's score nearby.

THE BEACH HOUSE LIVING ROOM

WHERE SAFETY BECOMES A WAITING ROOM

Wood-paneled walls, mismatched furniture, a back door left slightly ajar. At some point during the visit, a figure becomes visible through the gap. Just there.

FORMAT

DURATION	2 days / weekend
GROUP SIZE	4-6 people per slot
SLOTS/DAY	6-8 timed slots
TIME/GROUP	10-15 minutes
LOCATION	MICA Studios or Brickroom LA
CAPACITY	~500 total guests

ATMOSPHERE

- Disasterpeace score plays throughout all room
- No staff in character. No jumpscares.
- Lighting matches each scene exactly: the warm amber bedroom, the cold pool blue, the darkness of the street.
- Guests move at their own pace. The figure on the street is always there when they look.

WHAT EVERYONE WALKS OUT WITH

A craft envelope with the return address: Detroit, MI.

THE POLAROID

EVERYONE GETS ONE

Taken at entry and slipped into an envelope face-down. Handed back on the way out.

"You're never actually alone."

Printed on the back of every polaroid

CONDOM

OPTIONAL — GUESTS CAN TAKE ONE

In collaboration with Maude, brandished with a custom sleeve in their signature minimal design printed with "Pass it on" as a nod to how the curse is transmitted. It will sit in a bowl at the exit. No pressure, no explanation given.

LUCKY TICKET

5 PER DAY — HIDDEN IN A POLAROID ENVELOPE

One envelope per day contains a free screening ticket to They Follow. Nobody knows who has it until they open theirs.

FROM REINTRODUCTION TO SEQUEL LAUNCH

01 WKS 1-3 SEED

Creator briefings begin

Instagram campaign launches

Film boosted on On Digital

02 WKS 4-7 IGNITE

Scavenger hunt Phases 1+2

Fangoria cover drops

Venue screenings announced

Creator content wave

03 WKS 8-10 EVENT

Experiential Pop-Up Event

Scavenger hunt IRL

Q&A screenings at both venues

Press day - cast + creators

04 WK 11+ HANDOFF

They Follow trailer drops via QR

Final push messaging

Reddit AMA with director

The campaign closes and the sequel arrives!

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

35M+

Total social impressions across all campaign phases

500K+

New or returning It Follows streams during the campaign window

5K+

Scavenger hunt participants across LA and NYC

2K+

Attended in-person screenings and pop-up events

CREATOR EARNED MEDIA

Minimum 8 long-form pieces across YouTube, Fangoria, Bloody Disgusting, Dead Meat, etc. Each drives sustained traffic beyond initial publish date.

PRESS REACH

Target 25+ editorial placements: Fangoria, A.V. Club, Consequence, The Ringer, Variety, IndieWire. Campaign is positioned to reach all of these.

UGC VELOCITY

#ItFollows target: 5K+ fan submissions in the campaign window.

SEQUEL CONVERSION

They Follow ticket demand directly traceable via scavenger hunt QR redemptions and screening-to-sequel ticket conversion tracking.

WHY THIS WORKS

- 01** Fan-first, not ad-first. Every activation earns attention by being genuinely interesting, not by buying it.
 - 02** It meets fans where they already are, Instagram, Reddit, TikTok, and arthouse cinemas.
 - 03** Builds a community of investigation. Horror fans who feel like they discovered something become the loudest advocates.
 - 04** Makes It Follows part of the 2026 conversation, not a nostalgia footnote. The sequel gets a primed, excited audience.
 - 05** The mechanics of the campaign mirror the mechanics of the film: something slow, quiet, and unstoppable. The medium is the message.
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